

*agers do.* In our seminar on biblical principles for operating a business, one of the principles we teach is what happens when employers don't establish definitive standards for employees. The employees don't know what is expected.

We need to establish standards for our children, including timeliness, dependability, attitude, and honor. These are the standards by which God evaluates success or failure.

I have a friend who uses his business to provide job opportunities for young people just starting out. He says he is continually amazed at the lack of responsibility on the part of many young people, even from Christian homes. He expects no special job knowledge from the teenagers he hires, but he has two absolute standards: be to work on time—every day, and maintain a good attitude.

If they adhere to these standards and *try*, he will train them thoroughly. He told me the story of Greg, a young man he hired. Greg came from a broken home and had been raised by a Christian grandmother. When Greg came to his company through a work-study program at his high school, he was enthusiastic about a chance to work at something with a future.

Greg proved to be bright and enthusiastic but on the undisciplined side. He was prompt and dependable for the first couple of weeks, but then began to be late periodically and call in with a variety of excuses for why he couldn't come to work.

My friend suffered through Greg's bad habits until summer because Greg showed such promise when he *was* working. After being disciplined, he would improve for awhile and then lapse back into his bad habits.

During the summer school break, Greg was employed full-time. But he was often tardy and periodically just didn't show up at all. Each time he was apologetic, but the cycle continued. In conversations with his grandmother, she said, "He loves his job, but that boy just can't get out of bed in the mornings." She asked the owner to please not fire Greg. "He wants to work; he just never had a real job before."

Finally, in desperation, my friend sent one of his supervisors by Greg's home in the mornings to get him up and in to work.